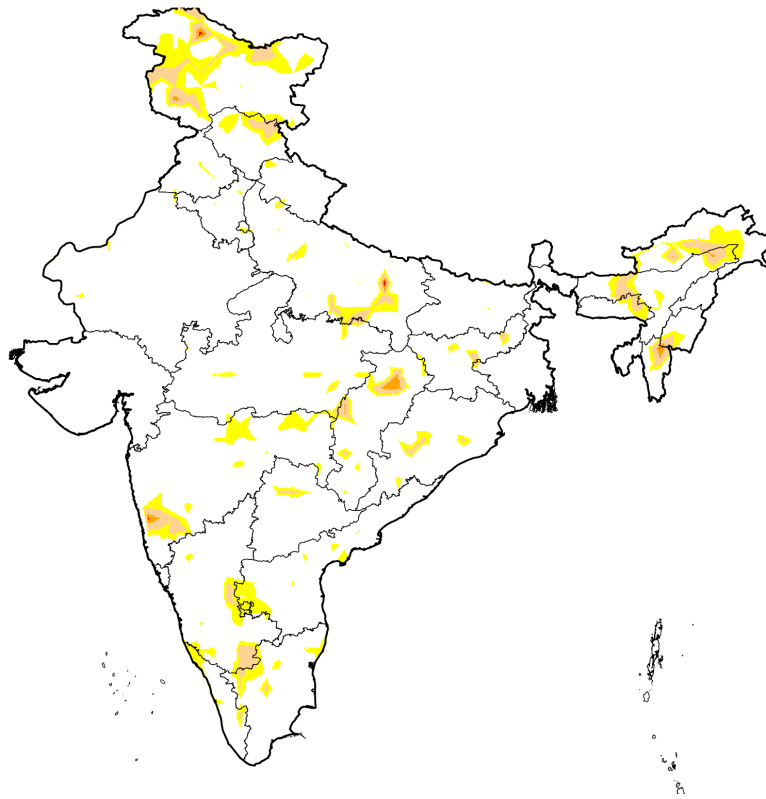




Combined Drought Index (CDI) for the week ending May 20, 2026.

Summary

The national drought situation this week shows that the majority of India remains in the Normal category, with 84.7% of the area classified as Normal. The total area experiencing drought conditions, specifically D0 and above, was 15.3% this week. This figure reflects a contraction in the drought area compared to previous periods, as the total drought area decreased by 0.9 percentage points week-on-week, moving from 16.2% in the last week to 15.3% currently. The regions most affected by drought are NCT of Delhi with 52.2% of its area in drought, followed by Manipur at 42.3%, Mizoram at 40.8%, Arunachal Pradesh at 40.3%, Jammu & Kashmir at 38.9%, and Meghalaya at 34.1%. Conversely, West Bengal reported 0.0% of its area in drought, while Rajasthan was the least affected state with 1.0% of its area in drought.

Regional Outlook

North Moderate, scattered drought. About 28% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northwest Largely normal conditions. About 4% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Northeast Moderate, scattered drought. About 27% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

East Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 7% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

Central Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 15% of the area is in drought (D0–D4). Pockets of severe-or-worse conditions are present.

West Moderate, scattered drought. About 22% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).

South Mostly normal, with localised dryness. About 16% of the area is in drought (D0–D4).